

it is now one of the fastest-growing economies in the world. Sales of industrial robots in India reached a new record of 4,771 new units installed in 2018—an increase of 39 per cent compared to the previous year (2017: 3,412 units). India now ranks eleventh worldwide in terms of annual installations, claims IFR. The Indian industrial robotics market was evaluated at 4,564 units in 2018 and is estimated to grow at 13.3 per cent CAGR in the coming three to four years.

Challenges of robotics in manufacturing

Robotics has considerably reduced several pains of the manufacturing process, including reduction in the cost of operations. But there are various obstacles faced by manufacturers while installing robotics in their units. These are as follows:

Training and skillset. When new robots are installed in the units, a new form of training and skills are required for the employees. They have to be

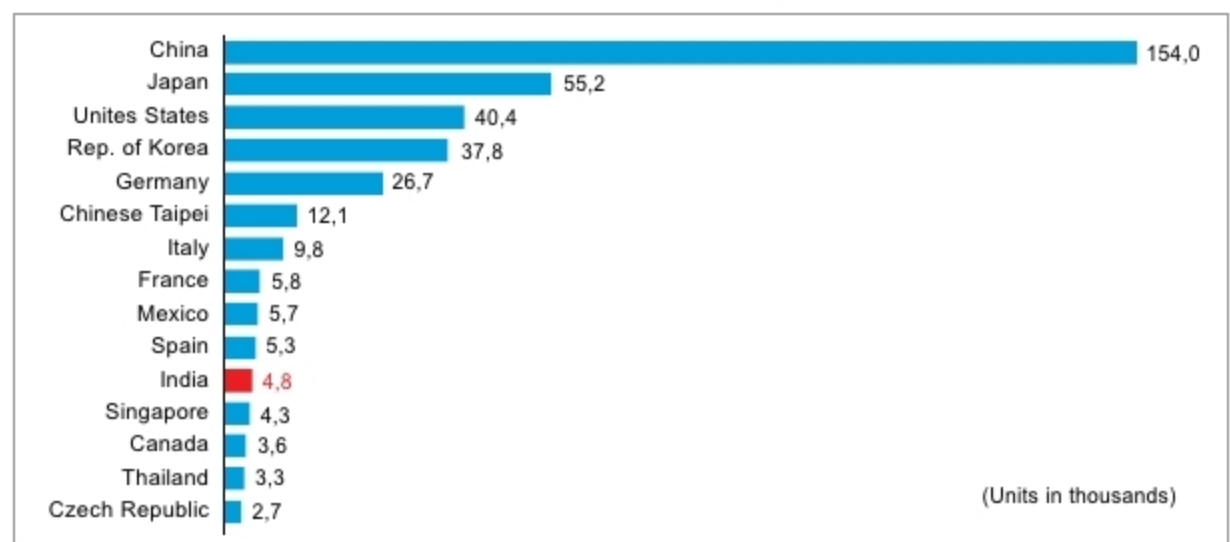


Fig. 3: Annual installations of industrial robots—15 largest markets 2018 (Source: World Robotics 2019)

trained on how to operate in this new environment. Also, companies have to look for a few other employees who have the necessary qualifications in handling robotics

Safety measurements. There is a saying that every development comes at some cost, and the same is the case with robotics. The industrial robots come with several safety hazards to the units, and strict regulations have to be maintained. Manufacturers have to look for and take all the necessary

precautions before installing robots.

Budget. For the industrial robots, a huge upfront cost is associated, though their prices are now decreasing. The volume of production and sales level will have to remain stable during the speculated ROI timeline to compensate for the initial investment.

Apart from manufacturers, robot makers themselves face several tough challenges. These challenges are hindering the practicality of professional services of robotics in businesses. **EFY**

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